

Analytics Case Study - Wahoo Inc. by Luke Liska and Brandon Banning

*Company information is adapted from (<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Dell>) and needed when answering the questions.

Wahoo* is an American multinational computer technology company based in Tampa, Florida, United States, that develops, sells, repairs, and supports computers and related products and services. Named after its founder, Michael Wahoo, the company is one of the largest technological corporations in the world, employing more than 103,300 people in the U.S. and around the world.

Wahoo sells personal computers (PCs), servers, data storage devices, network switches, software, computer peripherals, HDTVs, cameras, printers, MP3 players, and electronics built by other manufacturers. The company is well known for its innovations in supply chain management and electronic commerce, particularly its direct-sales model and its "build-to-order" or "configure to order" approach to manufacturing—delivering individual PCs configured to customer specifications. Wahoo was a pure hardware vendor for much of its existence, but with the acquisition in 2009 of Mackerel Systems, Wahoo entered the market for IT services. The company has since made additional acquisitions in storage and networking systems, with the aim of expanding their portfolio from offering computers only to delivering complete solutions for enterprise customers.

Wahoo was listed at number 51 in the Fortune 500 list, until 2014. After going private in 2013, the newly confidential nature of its financial information prevents the company from being ranked by Fortune. In 2015, it was the third largest PC vendor in the world after Lenovo and HP. Wahoo is currently the #1 shipper of PC monitors in the world.

In 2018, Wahoo acquired the enterprise technology firm Marlin Corporation; following the completion of the purchase, Wahoo and Marlin became divisions of Wahoo Technologies.

It is January, 2019, and you have been recently hired by Wahoo as a consultant to evaluate their digital marketing strategy. During your initial meeting January 5th, you wrote down 10 major observations that you wanted to look into deeper. For each observation, please indicate which direction you will take and why, paying close attention to items you learned while listening to a guest speaker in your Digital Marketing class. Your notes are listed below, followed by italicized questions to be answered (by you). You will not receive credit if you do not explain why.

1. Wahoo CEO is interested in studying the impact that hurricanes have on their online web traffic. The CEO recommended running an A/B test on traffic levels during a hurricane in the next month to determine whether or not they need to make a custom online interface to improve traffic during hurricane season. *Do you recommend following the CEO's recommendation? Please explain why or why not.*

2. The Director of Marketing gave you a study run for 24 hours on Black Friday with a sample size of 10,000 unique visitors to the website. Based on this study, he

recommends changing the homepage for the rest of the year to focus on products that are on sale as opposed to focusing on the new innovative products Wahoo sells. Do you agree with his conclusion? Please explain why or why not.

3. Wahoo Inc. is currently running an ad campaign on social media to introduce a new product using a last interaction attribution model. The Wahoo Inc. social media intern recommends switching to use a first interaction attribution model. Do you recommend following the Intern's recommendation? Please explain why or why not.
4. The in-house statistician mentioned that when it is sunny outside, online sales decrease. He recommends running an advertisement on a movie streaming service (such as Hulu) during sunny weather to increase traffic to the website during these low traffic times. Do you recommend following the statistician's recommendation? Please explain why or why not.
5. The Wahoo Inc. CMO has agreed to increase the advertising budget by 10% the following quarter. Currently, their advertising budget is \$1,200,000. She is looking for your guidance as to which advertising campaign to focus on. Based on the data chart below, which advertising platform would you recommend? Please explain why or why not.

	<u>Estimated Clicks Lost</u>	<u>Conversion Rate</u>	<u>Average Order Value (Revenue)</u>	<u>Average CPC (Cost Per Click)</u>
<u>Campaign 1</u>	<u>120,000</u>	<u>1.20%</u>	<u>\$600</u>	<u>\$3.50</u>
<u>Campaign 2</u>	<u>100,000</u>	<u>0.50%</u>	<u>\$800</u>	<u>\$4.25</u>

Hint: You will need to calculate: Conversions Lost, Revenue Lost, Estimated Cost, and Return on Ad Spend.

BONUS (10pts): Is their estimated increase in advertising budget at an optimal level (i.e. should it be increased or decreased)? Please explain why or why not.

Elijah

MEETING AIM

To explore how even when we feel we've failed, God can set us on our feet to start again.

BIBLE PASSAGE

1 Kings 19

BACKGROUND

This session plan is intended for use either in-person or online, depending on how you're meeting. Adapt the activities to fit your situation.

Elijah, one of the greatest fathers of the faith is, in this passage, brought low. Here we discover his vulnerability, his sense of failure, his need for physical rest and recovery, and his need to start again. This session explores how even when we feel that we have failed, God can put us back on our feet, ready to walk a different path with him.

STARTING OUT—5 mins

Start your time together with some simple refreshments. Ask the group to think about how we measure success or failure. What recent successes have you enjoyed? (Scoring a goal for the team, getting a place in the school choir etc.) What about failures? Do we like to share these or would we rather keep them to ourselves?

INTRO ACTIVITY—10 mins

You will need: the song 'Get back up again' from the film *Trolls* and the means to play it. Explain to the group where this song comes in the film. Despite all the danger facing the trolls, Princess Poppy, the eternal optimist, goes off on her solo journey in her quest to save the trolls. Play the song and challenge the children to think about whether Poppy's attitude is realistic or even helpful. Explain that today, we are going to be looking at the story of one character in the Bible whose response was quite different.

BIBLE STORY—10 mins

You will need: materials to create a cave, such as a table, blankets, rugs and cushions; a large rug, blanket or sheet; a large pot plant

Before the session, build the cave in one corner of our space. Lay out the desert in the middle and put the plant on the edge of the desert furthest from the cave. If you have lots of time, you could get the children to help you do this at the start of your Bible time. Gather the children in the desert and begin the story:

Elijah, God's messenger was on the run. He had delivered a message from God to the people and the people hadn't liked it. The queen had threatened his life and he had run away. Now he found himself alone in the desert, exhausted, scared and feeling let down by God. He found a large bush, laid under it, begged God to let him die! Then he fell asleep. *Invite the children to sit by the plant.*

Suddenly, an angel woke Elijah, gave him water to drink and bread to eat. The angel cared for Elijah until he was ready to move on, out of the desert. Soon, Elijah was feeling better. So much so that he walked across the desert for 40 days. He reached Mount Horeb and rested in a cave. *Walk the group around the desert and then sit down by the cave.*

Here God called out to Elijah: "What are you doing here?"

Elijah was still feeling hurt and frustrated. He told God how he felt let down by God, how wrong it was that God would let these people chase him down, even after all he had done to serve God. Why didn't God punish them and protect Elijah? Elijah wanted to stop his work as God's

messenger.

But God didn't want Elijah to stop working for him. Instead, he had looked after Elijah. He had sent the angel to care for him, he had given him safe places to rest in the desert, he had given him the rest he needed.

Now, here at the mountain, God gave Elijah the chance to share his frustrations. Then God appeared to Elijah, not as someone you could see, but as a gentle whisper that Elijah could feel and be reminded that God was right with him.

God would give Elijah new work to do, and a helper to go with him. Elijah was struggling, but he was not beaten. God was with him.

CHATTING TOGETHER—5 mins

Ask the children these questions, encouraging everyone to take turns to contribute:

- What is your favourite part of this story?
- What challenges you about this story?
- How would you have felt, if you were Elijah?
- What would you like to say to Elijah?
- If you were Elijah, what would you say to God?

CREATIVE TIME—10 mins

You will need: Lego and Lego baseboards; marbles; sticky labels; pens

The children could work together in pairs or small groups to complete this activity. Distribute the Lego baseboards and Lego and invite the children to create marble mazes. Give them a marble to test out their mazes, before exchanging mazes with one another to test them out.

As you create, improve, develop and test the marble mazes. Talk about how we sometimes feel 'stopped in our tracks', as the marble is in the maze and as Elijah felt in the story. How does life feel like a dead end? What things might we struggle with along the way? Give the children sticky labels and pens and invite them to label some of the 'dead ends' perhaps with the things Elijah struggled with, or perhaps some of their own feelings of reaching the 'end' of a track.

Remind the group that God didn't allow Elijah to stay stuck in the 'dead end'. Talk about how God set Elijah back on track again. Ask the group what this may mean for us.

PRAYER—5 mins

As you pray, invite the children to create some actions for the words: struggle, dead end, rest and new path. Then pray this prayer:

'Father God, sometimes life feels like a struggle. We may feel like we've reached a dead end, worn out by the challenges that bring us down. Help us to rest in you. Set us on a new path, following the life you want us to live. Amen.'

Make yourself available to talk about any particular challenges the children may be facing, to pray about these and to support the children in getting any further support they may need.

BECKY MAY

is founder of The Resources Cupboard, resourcing the local church to make young disciples: theresourcescupboard.co.uk.